PATTERN GENERATOR WITH EARLY EXIT

```java
public class PatternGenerator {
    public static void main(String[] args) {

        int size = 5;

        for (int row = 1; row <= size; row++) {
            for (int col = 1; col <= size; col++) {

                // Skip printing the third column
                if (col == 3) {
                    continue;
                }

                // Stop the entire pattern when row 4 reaches column 4
                if (row == 4 && col == 4) {
                    break;
                }

                System.out.print("* ");
            }

            System.out.println();
        }
    }
}
```

```
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* * * *
* * * *
* *
* * * *

[Program finished]
```